

PURPOSE: To specify that students can carry certain types of pepper spray on campus to defend themselves and define disciplinary measures if it is used incorrectly.

INTRODUCED BY: Senator Courtney

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Pepper Spray: An aerosol spray containing oils derived from cayenne pepper, irritating to the eyes and respiratory passages and used as a disabling weapon.

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

Though MSMS prides itself on student safety, unforeseen incidents can occur due to the railroad that creates an open campus. For example, there was an incident in Goen Hall not too long ago involving three men who made their way into the inside of the dorm. This being said, students must have a way to defend themselves.

Pepper spray is not specifically mentioned in the handbook under prohibited items or allowed items on campus. This creates confusion because some deem it a weapon and assume that it would not be allowed. According to stunster.com, Pepper Spray is legal for individuals to carry, purchase, and use for self-defense in the state of Mississippi. More importantly, Pepper spray is not prohibited in the bylaws of MUW, whose campus rules MSMS is required to follow.

With the specification of allowing pepper spray on campus, rules must also be specified and created. For example, accidental activation of pepper spray that harms another student would be a level two infraction, for it falls under horseplay that causes another student bodily harm. Specific assault on another student using pepper spray with the intention of hurting them is a level three, for it falls under assault on another person.

Specifying that Pepper spray is indeed allowed on campus would clear up confusion and allow students to feel safer walking alone.

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On page 81 of the Student Handbook (PDF page 86) under the section “Approved and Non-approved Items” the following would be changed to:

Some of the items a student may wish to bring are: ~~Pepper-spray,~~ bed spread or comforter, clothes iron with automatic shut-off (MSMS provides ironing boards), a one-cup coffee dispenser with automatic shut-off similar to a Keurig, desk light/lamp, cell phone, posters/pictures, personal computer, surge protectors, comfortable desk chair (school provides

standard plastic chairs), lock box, sports equipment, dry erase board for messages, musical instruments, and a bathing suit. Fans are strongly suggested.

RL.22. The following items are prohibited:

Laser pointers	Non-power strip extension cords	Motorized scooters
Televisions	Cooking appliances ¹	Heated blankets
Monitors/Displays larger than 40"	Hammocks	Portable heaters
Couches over 6 feet long	Exercise Weights ³	Weapons ⁴
Handcuffs	Burning Incense	Pets
Martial arts equipment ⁵	Dangerous scientific equipment	Open flame items like candles
Halogen lights	Darts and dartboards	Empty alcohol containers used as decorations
Spray paint/	Fixatives/other harmful aerosols	Volatile, caustic/corrosive, and/or flammable solvents ⁶
Toxic glues/cements/other adhesives	Items removed from public spaces ⁷	

This list is not intended to be all inclusive. The school reserves the right to disallow additional items if needed.

1 This includes, but is not limited to, microwave ovens, popcorn poppers, hot plates, toasters/toaster ovens, coffeemakers with hot plates, heating coils, etc.

2 A weight room is available on campus.

3 This includes, but not limited to, knives with serrated or sharpened edges, razor blades, box cutters, X-acto knives, and novelty advertising tools/items with sharp blades.

4 If approved for classes, such items may be stored in the office. **Pepper spray is not prohibited.**

5 This includes, but is not limited to, turpentine, mineral spirits, and denatured alcohol.

6 This includes, but is not limited to highway/street/traffic/business/parking signs or orange cones removed without consent.